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FLOAT PLAN

INSTRUCTIONS: Complete this plan before you go boating and leave it with a reliable person who can be depended upon to notify the Coast Guard, or other rescue agency, should you not return or check-in as planned. If you have a change of plans, or will be delayed, notify the person holding your Float Plan. Finally, close your plan by notifying the holder you have arrived home safely and if the holder has reported you overdue, notify all applicable rescue authorities of your safe return.



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Do NOT file this plan with the Coast Guard

VESSEL

IDENTIFICATION:

Name & Hailing Port Big Blue
 Document / Registration No. _____ HIN _____
 Year, Make & Model _____
 Length 30 Type _____ Draft _____ Hull Mat. _____
 Hull & Trim Colors white
 Prominent Features _____

COMMUNICATION:

Radio Call Sign / Number _____
 DSC MMSI No. _____
 Radio-1: Type _____ Ch. / Freq. Monitored _____
 Radio-2: Type _____ Ch. / Freq. Monitored _____
 Cell / Satellite _____
 Email _____

PROPULSION:

Primary-- Type Eng. _____ Fuel Capacity _____ Auxiliary--Type _____
 Diesel OB _____ Eng. _____ Fuel Capacity _____

NAVIGATION: (Check all onboard)

☐ Compass ☐ Radar ☐ GPS / DGPS ☐ Depth Sounder
☐ Charts ☐ Maps ☐ _____

SAFETY & SURVIVAL

VISUAL DISTRESS SIGNALS:

☐ Electric Distress Light (night only)
☐ Flag (day only)
☐ Flare, Aerial (day & night)
☐ Flare, Handheld (day & night)
☐ Signal Mirror (day only)
☐ Smoke (day only)

AUDIBLE DISTRESS SIGNALS:

☐ Bell
☐ Horn
☐ Whistle

EPIRB:

UIN* _____

ADDITIONAL GEAR:

☐ Anchor - Line length _____
☐ Dewatering device
☐ Exposure suits
☐ Fire Extinguisher
☐ Flashlight / Searchlight
☐ Raft / Dinghy
☐ Food for _____ days / person
☐ Water for _____ days / person
☐ _____
☐ _____
☐ _____

PERSONS ONBOARD

OPERATOR:

Name _____ Has experience with: ☐ this vessel; ☐ the boating area(s).
 Address _____ Home Phone _____
 City _____ State _____ Zip Code _____ Vehicle (Year, Make & Model) _____
 Age _____ Gender _____ PFD ☐ PLB UIN* _____ Vehicle License No. _____ Trailer ☐
 Note _____ Vehicle parked at _____
 Float Plan Note Auto-generated from route USER_ROUTE_4_260530144547_65b5f (SINGLE_MASTER). Chicago to Chicago. 4233 NM, 68 locks.

PASSENGERS / CREW: (Identify all on board)

Name	Home Phone	Age	Gender	PFD	Note
1. _____	_____	_____	_____	☐	_____
2. _____	_____	_____	_____	☐	_____
3. _____	_____	_____	_____	☐	_____
4. _____	_____	_____	_____	☐	_____
5. _____	_____	_____	_____	☐	_____
6. _____	_____	_____	_____	☐	_____
7. _____	_____	_____	_____	☐	_____
8. _____	_____	_____	_____	☐	_____
9. _____	_____	_____	_____	☐	_____
10. _____	_____	_____	_____	☐	_____
11. _____	_____	_____	_____	☐	_____
12. _____	_____	_____	_____	☐	_____

Passenger PLB UIN*
 (Not listed in a specific order)

If you have a genuine concern for the safety or welfare of the persons onboard this vessel that have not returned or checked-in, in a reasonable amount of time, then follow the step-by-step instructions on the Boating Emergency Guide™ located on the last page of this Float Plan.

(*) EPIRB and PLB registration required by Federal regulations. www.beaconregistration.noaa.gov



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FLOAT PLAN continued

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CONTACTS

Contact 1 _____ Phone Number _____
 Contact 2 _____ Phone Number _____
 Rescue Authority _____ Phone Number _____

ITINERARY

		DATE	TIME	LOCATION / WAYPOINT	MODE OF TRAVEL	REASON FOR STOP	CHECK-IN TIME
1	Depart			Chicago - Start of Trip			
2	Arrive			Chicago - End of Trip			
	Depart						
3	Arrive						
	Depart						
4	Arrive						
	Depart						
5	Arrive						
	Depart						
6	Arrive						
	Depart						
7	Arrive						
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18	Arrive						
	Depart						
19	Arrive						
	Depart						
20	Arrive						
	Depart						
21	Arrive						

If you have a genuine concern for the safety or welfare of the persons onboard this vessel that have not returned or checked-in, in a reasonable amount of time, then follow the step-by-step instructions on the Boating Emergency Guide™ located on the last page of this Float Plan.

USCG Float Plan - BOATING EMERGENCY GUIDE™

BEFORE YOU BEGIN – This guide is designed to work either with or without a Float Plan. You will need the following items: 1) the Float Plan, if one was given to you; 2) a pen or pencil; 3) a clean sheet of paper or writing tablet; and 4) your local telephone directory.

Step 1: Do you have a genuine concern for the safety or welfare of any persons who have not returned or checked-in, in a reasonable amount of time?

If yes, then continue with **Step 2**. Otherwise **STOP** -- no further action is required at this time.

Step 2: Were you given a prepared Float Plan by anyone on board the vessel?

If yes, then continue with **Step 3**. Otherwise, go to **Step 5**.

Step 3: Locate the Contacts at the top of page 2 on the Float Plan. Call Contact number 1...

IF CONTACT #1	THEN						
Answers phone	Take notes during your conversation. - Let the person know you are responding to a late return or check-in by the individuals designated on the Float Plan. - Determine if the person you are talking to, or anyone else at that location, has recently had contact with anyone on the vessel, and when and where that contact occurred. - Are you still concerned about the safety or welfare of any persons on board the vessel?<table><tr><th>IF</th><th>THEN</th></tr><tr><td>Yes</td><td>Continue with Step 4.</td></tr><tr><td>No</td><td>STOP. No further action is required.</td></tr></table>	IF	THEN	Yes	Continue with Step 4 .	No	STOP . No further action is required.
IF	THEN						
Yes	Continue with Step 4 .						
No	STOP . No further action is required.						
Does not answer phone	Continue with Step 4 .						

Step 4: Call Contact number 2...

IF CONTACT #2	THEN						
Answers phone	Take notes during your conversation. - Let the person know you are responding to a late return or check-in by the individuals designated on the Float Plan. - Determine if the person you are talking to, or anyone else at that location, has recently had contact with anyone on the vessel, and when and where that contact occurred. - Are you still concerned about the safety or welfare of any persons on board the vessel?<table><tr><th>IF</th><th>THEN</th></tr><tr><td>Yes</td><td>Continue with Step 6.</td></tr><tr><td>No</td><td>STOP. No further action is required.</td></tr></table>	IF	THEN	Yes	Continue with Step 6 .	No	STOP . No further action is required.
IF	THEN						
Yes	Continue with Step 6 .						
No	STOP . No further action is required.						
Does not answer phone	Continue with Step 6 .						

Step 5: Using the checklist below, jot down only what you know about each item:

DO NOT SPECULATE. Incorrect information may mislead Search and Rescue personnel; add to the overall search and rescue time; and adversely affect the outcome.

- ☐ Period of time the vessel has been overdue.
- ☐ Purpose of the trip or voyage.
- ☐ Description of vessel. (Type, size, color, features, etc.)
- ☐ Vessel's departure point and destination.
- ☐ Places the vessel planned to stop during transit.
- ☐ Navigation equipment aboard. (Examples: GPS, radar, compass, sounder, etc.)
- ☐ Number of persons aboard. Relevant characteristics such as dependability, reliability, etc.
- ☐ Was the vessel initially docked or moored or did a vehicle tow it to a launch point?
- ☐ License plate number and description of the tow vehicle and/or the passenger's transport vehicle.
- ☐ Communications equipment aboard, including type of radio and frequencies monitored, cellular or satellite telephone numbers of individuals, etc.
- ☐ Additional points of contact along the vessel's planned route.
- ☐ Operator and/or a passenger/crew member absolutely had to be back at the scheduled return time.
- ☐ Call your local Rescue Authority that responds to marine emergencies (Police, Sheriff, Constable, First responder, etc.).

Go to **Step 6-2**.

Step 6:

- Call the Rescue Authority contact at the top of page 2 on the Float Plan.
- Tell the dispatcher you are responding to a late return or check-in by the persons on board the vessel.
- The dispatcher will instruct you from there.

Note: The dispatcher will provide you with the necessary contact or agency connection to get a search and rescue mission started. This puts you in direct contact with the agency conducting the actual search and rescue, eliminating unnecessary middlemen.
The dispatcher will tell you if he/she desires a follow-up call on the outcome of the rescue.

- Continue with **Step 7**.

Step 7: Be patient... you've done everything you can possibly do for now. It is important to keep the telephone available so emergency personnel can contact you with additional information and/or questions concerning the search and rescue effort.

STOP -- End of Guide

Provided as a courtesy by:
<Unit or Organization Name>
<City>, <State>
<phone number>
<website URL>

Get a Vessel Safety Check before you go boating.



The USCG Float Plan is the official Float Plan of the U.S. Coast Guard and U.S. Coast Guard Auxiliary. For more information visit:

www.floatplancentral.org